

Evidence of the Intercession of the Prophet (ﷺ)

إِسْمَاءُ الْأَرْبَعِينَ فِي شَفَاعَةِ سَيِّدِ الْمَحْبُوبِينَ

**“The Transmission of
Forty Hadiths on the
Intercession of the
Master of the Beloveds”**

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Read this first!

On the Day of Judgement, the sun will be directly overhead, and its intense heat will cause minds to boil. The more sinful a person is, the greater their suffering will be. Sweat will flow so much from their bodies that after being absorbed seventy yards into the ground, it will rise back up, reaching the ankles of some, the knees of others, some up to their chests, and some even to their throats. The severity of thirst will be such that tongues will dry up like thorns, and for some, their tongues will protrude out of their mouths. No one will care for another; parents, spouses, and children will all try to escape from one another. Amidst countless other calamities, when nearly half of the fifty-thousand-year-long Day of Judgement has passed, the people of the gathering will consult each other about finding an intercessor.

They will decide to present themselves before Prophet Adam (عَلَيْهِ السَّلَام) and request his intercession. However, he will direct them to Prophet Nuh (عَلَيْهِ السَّلَام) who will then direct them to Prophet Ibrahim (عَلَيْهِ السَّلَام) followed by Prophet Musa (عَلَيْهِ السَّلَام) and then to Prophet Isa (عَلَيْهِ السَّلَام). Eventually, after crying, wandering, and struggling, they will reach the court of the Master of both Worlds, the Intercessor of Sinners, Prophet Muhammad ﷺ. There, His Noble Eminence will receive the glad tidings of intercession, and thus, the process of intercession will begin.

It should be remembered that the Grand Intercession (Shaf'āat-e-Kubra) is one of the unique distinctions of the Leader of both Worlds ﷺ. Until he opens the door of intercession, no one else will be able to intercede. Even those who will intercede must first bring their intercession before the court of the Prophet ﷺ.¹

The station of intercession has been granted to the Prophet ﷺ and anyone who denies his intercession in any form is misguided.²

May Allāh Almighty grant this book acceptance in His Majestic Court and honour me with the Shaf'āat of My Master ﷺ on the Day of Judgement.

اٰمِيْنُ بِجَاہِ خَاتَمِ النَّبِيِّیْنَ ﷺ

Bilal Shabir Attari Madani.

¹ Bahar-e-Shariat, vol. 1, p. 70, summarised

² Bahar-e-Shariat, vol. 1, p. 72, summarised

Foreword

In the noble mission of **Dawat-e-Islami, Jāmi‘ah al-Madīnah** plays a pivotal role in nurturing scholars grounded in Islamic knowledge and devoted to the propagation of the Sunnah. Among the towering personalities whose legacy continues to illuminate the path of scholarship and spirituality is **A‘lā Hazrat Imām Aḥmad Razā Khān رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ** the great reviver of Islām in the 14th century Hijri. His encyclopaedic works, deep insight, and unwavering defence of Shar‘ah have guided generations of Muslims across the world.

To ensure that his intellectual and spiritual heritage reaches English-speaking audiences, **Majlis Jāmi‘ah al-Madīnah UK** established a dedicated department under the name “**Fikr-e-Razā**” (**The Vision of Razā**). The purpose of this department is to introduce English-speaking students and readers to the thought, scholarship, and reformative teachings of **A‘lā Hazrat Imām Aḥmad Razā Khān رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ**.

A vast portion of **A‘lā Hazrat’s** invaluable writings, including the monumental **Fatāwā Razawīyyah**, were authored in Urdu and Arabic. While these works hold immense relevance for contemporary Muslims, language barriers have limited their reach among English-speaking scholars and students. Recognising this need, Fikr-e-Razā undertook the task of translating selected treatises into fluent, accessible English while preserving the depth and precision of the original texts.

The present booklet,

(إِسْمَاعُ الْأَرْبَعِينَ فِي شَفَاعَةِ سَيِّدِ الْمَحْبُوبِينَ), translated as “Evidence of the Intercession of the Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ” This work, *Ism ‘āal-Arba‘īn fī Shaf‘āat Sayyid al-Mahbūbīn (The Transmission of Forty Hadiths on the Intercession of the Master of the Beloveds)*, has been compiled to present a collection of forty narrations that illuminate this blessed and hope-inspiring subject. At a time when certain voices attempt to cast doubt upon established Islamic teachings regarding the rank and honour of the Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ, the study of these narrations becomes even more important. The purpose of this collection is not merely academic; rather, it is to strengthen faith, increase love for the Messenger of

Allah ﷺ, and deepen certainty in the mercy that Allah has promised through him.

Originally written in Urdu and later translated into English by **Molana Bilal Shabir Attari Madani**, who is a hardworking teacher in Jamia Tul Madina Birmingham (UK) under the supervision of **Majlis Jāmi'ah al-Madīnah UK**, this work aims to convey the wisdom and reasoning of A'la Ḥaḍrat on this issue.

This translation is part of a broader effort to connect English-speaking students and communities in the UK with the intellectual and spiritual legacy of A'la Ḥaḍrat. By engaging with his writings, readers not only gain clarity in matters of Shar'ah but also strengthen their appreciation for the revivalist movement he inspired.

May Allah Almighty accept this humble endeavour, reward all those involved in its compilation, translation, and publication, and make it a means of spreading the blessed light of **Fikr-e-Razā** throughout the English-speaking world. Āmīn.

Khalid Tasneem Madani, Birmingham, UK

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Allāh's name I begin with, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful

Issue:

What do the scholars of religion say regarding the issue of the Prophet (ﷺ) being an intercessor? Which hadith establishes this? Please clarify, and you shall be rewarded.

Answer:

اَلْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ الْبَصِيْرِ السَّمِيْعِ وَالصَّلٰوةُ وَالسَّلَامُ عَلٰى الْبَشِيْرِ الشَّافِعِ وَعَلٰى اٰلِهٖ وَصَحْبِهٖ كُلِّ مَسَاءٍ وَسُطْحٍ.

All praise is due to Allah, the All-Hearing, the All-Seeing, and blessings and peace be upon the Bearer of Glad Tidings and the Intercessor, and upon his family and all his companions, every evening and morning.

سُبْحَنَ اللّٰه! Hearing such a question is astonishing, that Muslims and claimants of Sunnism fall into the calamity of doubting such clear beliefs! This too is a sign of the nearness of the Day of Judgement.

إِنَّا لِلّٰهِ وَإِنَّا إِلَيْهِ رَاجِعُونَ

“Indeed, we belong to Allah, and to Him we shall return.”

The hadiths regarding intercession are not something hidden! Dozens of Companions, hundreds of Tabi‘in, and thousands of Hadith scholars are its narrators. The books of Hadith, whether Şiḥāḥ, Sunan, Masānid, Maā’ijim, Jawāmi‘, and Muşannafāt, are filled with them.

1. Şiḥāḥ (Authentic Collections): These are hadith books in which only Şaḥiḥ (authentic) hadiths are included, such as Şaḥiḥ al-Bukhārī and Şaḥiḥ Muslim.
2. Sunan: These are hadith books arranged according to the chapters of Fiqh (Islamic jurisprudence) and contain only hadiths related to legal

rulings (Aḥkām), such as Sunan Abū Dāwūd.

3. Masānīd: These are hadith books in which the narrations of each companion (ṣaḥābī) are compiled separately, such as Musnad Imām Aḥmad.
4. Ma'ājīm: These are hadith books in which narrations are arranged according to the names of the shaykhs (teachers of the compiler), such as Mu'jam al-Ṭabarānī.
5. Jawāmi': These are hadith books that contain narrations under eight categories, which are: Siyar (biographies), Ādāb (manners), Tafsīr (Qur'anic exegesis), 'Aqā'id (beliefs), Fitan (tribulations), Aḥkām (legal rulings), Ashrāt (signs of the end times), and Manāqib (virtues of individuals or groups).
6. Muṣannafāt: These are hadith books arranged according to the chapters of Fiqh, but they include marfū' (sayings of the Prophet ﷺ) mawqūf (sayings of the Companions), and maqtū' (sayings of the Successors).¹

Every member of Ahl al-Sunnah, even women and children, and even uneducated villagers, is aware of this belief. The vision of Allah and the intercession of Muhammad (ﷺ) are matters that even children commonly affirm.

صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ وَبَارَكَ وَشَرَّفَ وَصَحَّدَ وَكَرَّمَ

“May Allah send blessings and peace upon him, grant him honour, elevate his status, and bestow upon him magnificence and nobility.”

This humble one, غفر الله تعالى له, May Allah Almighty forgive him,

Has compiled numerous hadiths of intercession in the treatise “Sam ‘wa ‘Ṭāh li Aḥādith al-Shaf'āh”, summarising and arranging them. Here, I will very

¹ Jāmi' al-Aḥādith, vol. 1, p. 567

concisely refer to forty hadiths and, before them, recite a few Qur'anic verses on the subject.

The Qurā'nic Verses

First Verse:

قَالَ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى: حَسْبَى أَنْ يَبْعَثَكَ رَبُّكَ مَقَامًا مَحْمُودًا ﴿٧٩﴾

Soon your Lord will elevate you upon a station where all will praise you.¹

In a noble hadith, it was asked from the Prophet (ﷺ),

“What is Maqām Maḥmūd?”

He replied: “(It is intercession.)”

Second Verse:

قَالَ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى: وَلَسَوْفَ يُعْطِيكَ رَبُّكَ فَتَرْضَى ﴿٨٠﴾

“And it is near that your Lord will certainly grant you so much that you will be pleased.²

In Musnad al-Firdaws by Daylami, it is narrated from Amīr al-Mu'minīn,

Mawlā ā'Alī (رضي الله عنه) that when this verse was revealed, the Prophet (ﷺ) said:

“Then I will not be pleased if even a single member of my Ummah remains in Hell.”

اَللّٰهُمَّ صَلِّ وَسَلِّمْ وَبَارِكْ عَلَيْهِ

¹ Al-Quran, Bani Isra'il, verse 79; translation from Kanz al-'Irfān

² Al-Quran, Al-Duha, verse 5; translation from Kanz al-'Irfān

“O Allah! Send blessings, peace, and blessings upon him.”

In Mu'jam al-Awsaṭ by Ṭabarānī and Musnad by Bazzār, it is narrated from Mawlā al-Muslimīn (رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ) that the Prophet (صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) said:

“I will intercede for my Ummah until my Lord calls upon me: ‘O Muhammad! Are you now pleased?’ And I will reply: ‘O my Lord! Yes, I am pleased.’”

Third Verse:

قَالَ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى: وَاسْتَغْفِرْ لِذُنُوبِكَ وَلِلْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَالْمُؤْمِنَاتِ^١

*seek forgiveness for the sins of your close ones and the believing men and women.*¹

In this verse, Allah commands His beloved (صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) to seek forgiveness for Muslim men and women. And what is intercession except this?

Fourth Verse:

قَالَ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى: وَلَوْ أَنَّهُمْ إِذْ ظَلَمُوا أَنْفُسَهُمْ جَاءُوكَ فَاسْتَغْفَرُوا اللَّهَ وَاسْتَغْفَرَ لَهُمُ الرَّسُولُ

لَوَجَدُوا اللَّهَ تَوَّابًا رَحِيمًا ﴿٦٣﴾

*And if, when they had wronged themselves 'Dear Beloved Prophet', they came to your court, then sought forgiveness from Allah, and the Messenger had prayed for their forgiveness 'too', then certainly they would have found Allah to be Most-Accepting of repentance, Most-Merciful.*²

This verse commands the Muslims that when they sin, they should come to the court of the Prophet (صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) and request his intercession, and that if the beloved (صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) intercedes, Allah (عَزَّوَجَلَّ) will surely forgive them.

¹ Al-Quran, Muhammad, verse 19; translation from Kanz al-ʿIrfān

² Al-Quran, Al-Nisa`, verse 64; translation from Kanz al-ʿIrfān

Fifth Verse:

قَالَ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى: وَإِذَا قِيلَ لَهُمْ تَعَالَوْا يَسْتَغْفِرْ لَكُمْ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ لَوَّارُؤُسَهُمْ

And when it is said to them, “Come, the Messenger of Allah will seek forgiveness for you”, they turn their heads;¹

In this verse, Allah describes the condition of the hypocrites, that they do not seek the intercession of the Prophet (ﷺ). Hence, those who do not seek intercession today will not receive it tomorrow.

May Allah grant us the honour of benefiting from the intercession of the Prophet ((ﷺ)) in this world and the Hereafter.

صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَى شَفِيعِ الْمُذْنِبِينَ وَآلِهِ وَصَحْبِهِ وَحُزْبِهِ أَجْمَعِينَ

“May Allah send blessings upon the Intercessor of sinners, and upon his family, companions, and all his followers.”

The Hadiths on Grand Intercession (Shaf'āat-e-Kubra)

The hadiths on Grand Intercession clearly state that on the plains of Mahshar (the Day of Judgement), the Day will be unbearably long, the sun will be overhead, and Hell will be nearby. On that day, the heat of the sun will be intensified to the extent of ten full years' worth of scorching heat, and it will be placed just above people's heads. The thirst will be unbearable, the heat unimaginable, and sweat will seep into the ground and rise back up, reaching even above people's throats. If a ship were to be placed in it, it would start floating. People will drown in their sweat, overwhelmed with fear and anxiety.

During this immense anguish and distress, people will desperately search for an intercessor. They will go from Prophet Adam to Prophet Nuh, then to Prophet Ibrahim, then to Prophet Musa, and then to Prophet 'Isa (peace be upon them

¹ Al-Quran, Al- Munāfiqūn, verse 5; translation from Kanz al-'Irfān

all). But each of them will say: "This is not my position. I am not worthy of this. I cannot do this. Myself! Myself! Go to someone else."

Eventually, after seeking intercession from every Prophet, the people will arrive at the court of the Most Radiant, the Seal of the Prophets, the Master of the First and the Last, the Intercessor of Sinners, the Mercy to the Worlds, Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ).

At that moment, the Prophet (ﷺ) will say:

"I am for this! I am for this!"

"I am the one appointed for intercession! I am the one for intercession!"

He will then proceed to the glorious court of his Lord and prostrate before Him. Then, the Almighty Lord will declare:

"يَا مُحَمَّدُ! اِرْقُمْ رَأْسَكَ وَقُلْ تُسَبِّحُ وَسَيَنْ تُعْطَى وَاشْفَعُ تُشَفَّعُ"

"O Muhammad! Raise your head, speak, you will be heard, ask, you will be granted, intercede, and your intercession will be accepted!"

This is Maqām-e-Maḥmūd (The Praised Station), where all the first and last generations will praise and glorify the Prophet (ﷺ) and it will become evident to all, believers and disbelievers alike, that no one holds a status before Allah as high as that of our Master (ﷺ).

For this reason, Allah, in His Infinite Wisdom, will first direct people's hearts to seek intercession from other Prophets. Only after they have turned away disappointed will they realise that the station of intercession exclusively belongs to the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ). No one else has the authority to open the door of intercession.

These hadiths are recorded in Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī and Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim and are well-known among the Muslims. There is no need to mention them in full as they are very lengthy. Anyone who has even read a little should refer to the Urdu translation of Mishkāt al-Maṣābiḥ or ask any Muslim to read it out to them.

Additionally, in these same hadiths, it is mentioned that after one intercession,

the Prophet (ﷺ) will repeatedly intercede again and again for the forgiveness of sinners. Each time, Allah (عَزَّوَجَلَّ) will grant him intercession, and with each request, a multitude of sinners will be saved.

Besides these famous hadiths, I am compiling forty more hadiths that are less known to the general public so that the faith of the believers is strengthened, and the hearts of the deniers burn in the fire of rage.

These hadiths will particularly refute the corrupt distortions made by certain irreligious individuals, Godless people, and false claimants who have misinterpreted the concept of intercession and attempted to conceal their rejection of intercession under a fabricated definition.

From these hadiths, it will be absolutely clear that our Greatest Master (ﷺ) is divinely appointed for intercession, and his blessed court is the **only** refuge for the helpless. There is no room for the heretical claim that Allah can appoint whomever He wishes as an intercessor. These hadiths will make it abundantly clear that Allah and His Messenger (ﷺ) have openly and explicitly identified the one and only intercessor, none other than Muhammad, the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ).

Intercession is not just for those who accidentally commit a sin and remain fearful and regretful all their lives, as some deviants suggest. They claim that a thief who committed theft only once, repented, and remained terrified is eligible for intercession.

No! No!

By the Lord who made him the Intercessor of Sinners (ﷺ)!

His intercession is for the sinners like us, for the wretched and disgraceful, for the criminals and wrongdoers, for those drowned in sin from head to toe, for those whose sins are so great that even sin itself feels ashamed of their name.

ترسم آلوده شود امان عصیان از من

“I fear that even the fabric of sin itself might become tainted by my misdeeds!”

Allah alone is sufficient for us, and He is the Best Disposer of affairs.

صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَى الشَّافِعِ الْجَبِيلِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَصَحْبِهِ بِأَلْوَفِ التَّجِيلِ

“May Allah send countless blessings and peace upon the Beautiful Intercessor (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) and upon his family and companions, with thousands of honours and reverence.”

وَالْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ

“And all praise is due to Allah, the Lord of all worlds.”

Hadith 1 & 2:

Imam Aḥmad, with a Ṣaḥīḥ (authentic) chain, narrates in his Musnad from ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Umar (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا), and Ibn Mājah narrates from Abū Mūsā al-Ash‘arī (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ) that the Prophet (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) said:

خُيِّرْتُ بَيْنَ الشَّفَاعَةِ وَبَيْنَ أَنْ يَدْخُلَ نِصْفُ أُمَّتِي الْجَنَّةَ فَأَخْتَرْتُ الشَّفَاعَةَ لِأَنَّهَا أَعْمُ وَأَكْثَى، أَتَرُونَهَا لِلْمُتَّقِينَ ؎ ! لَا وَلَكِنَّهَا
لِلْمُذْنِبِينَ الْخَطَّائِينَ الْمُسْكِرِينَ

“I was given the choice between intercession or half of my Ummah entering Paradise. I chose intercession because it is more encompassing and more beneficial. Do you think it is for the pious? No! Rather, it is for the sinful, the wrongdoers, and those stained with sins.”

اللهم صل وسلم وبارك عليه والحمد لله رب العالمين

“O Allah! Send blessings, peace, and blessings upon him, and all praise is due to Allah, the Lord of all worlds.”

Hadith 3:

Ibn ‘Adī narrates from Umm al-Mu‘minīn Umm Salamah (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا) that the Prophet (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) said:

شَفَاعَتِي لِهَٰلِكِينَ مِنْ أُمَّتِي

“My intercession is for those from my Ummah who have been ruined by their sins.”

Indeed, this is the truth!

O my Intercessor, may I be sacrificed for you!

صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْكَ

“May Allah send blessings upon you!”

Hadiths 4–8:

Abū Dāwūd, Tirmidhī, Ibn Ḥibbān, Ḥākim, and Bayhaqī (with authentication) narrate from Anas ibn Mālik (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ).

Tirmidhī, Ibn Mājah, Ibn Ḥibbān, and Ḥākim narrate from Jābir ibn ‘Abdullāh (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ).

Ṭabarānī in Al-Mu‘jam al-Kabīr narrates from ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Abbās (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا).

Khaṭīb al-Baghdādī narrates from ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Umar (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا) and Ka‘b ibn ‘Ujrah (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ) that the Prophet (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) said:

شَفَاعَتِي يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ لَأَهْلِ الْكِبَائِرِ مِنْ أُمَّتِي

“My intercession on the Day of Judgement is for those of my Ummah who committed major sins.”

صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْكَ وَسَلَامَ وَالْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ

“May Allah send blessings and peace upon you, and all praise is due to Allah, the Lord of all worlds.”

Hadith 9:

Abū Bakr Aḥmad ibn ‘Alī al-Baghdādī narrates from Abū al-Dard ‘ā(رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ) that the Prophet (صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) said:

شَفَاعَتِي لِأَهْلِ الدُّنُوبِ مِنْ أُمَّتِي

“My intercession is for the sinners of my Ummah.”

Abū al-Dard ‘ā(رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ) asked:

وَإِنْ ذُنِّي وَإِنْ سَرَقَ

“Even if they committed adultery and theft?”

The Prophet (صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) replied:

وَإِنْ ذُنِّي وَإِنْ سَرَقَ عَلَى رَغَمِ أَنْفِ أَبِي الدَّرَدَاءِ

“Even if they committed adultery and theft, despite the disapproval of Abū al-Dard ‘ā!”

Hadith 10 & 11:

Ṭabarānī and Bayhaqī narrate from Buraydah (رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ).

Ṭabarānī in Al-Mu‘jam al-Awsaṭ narrates from Anas (رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ) that the Prophet (صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) said:

أَنْ أَشْفَعَ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ لَأَكْثَرِ مَبَاعِلٍ عَلَى وَجْهِ الْأَرْضِ مِنْ شَجَرٍ وَحَجَرٍ وَمَذَرٍ

“I will intercede on the Day of Judgement for more people than the number of trees, stones, and clods of earth on the surface of the earth.”

Hadith 12:

Bukhārī, Muslim, Ḥākim, and Bayhaqī narrate from Abū Hurayrah (رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ).

(The following wording is from Ḥākim and Bayhaqī.)

The Prophet (ﷺ) said:

شَفَاعَتِي لِمَنْ شَهِدَ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ مُخْلِصًا يَصْدِقُ قَلْبُهُ لِسَانَهُ

“My intercession is for every person who sincerely testifies that there is none worthy of worship except Allāh, with a heart that affirms what the tongue has declared.”

Hadith 13:

Aḥmad, Ṭabarānī, and Bazzār narrate from Muā‘dh ibn Jabal and Abū Mūsā al-Ash‘arī (رضي الله عنهما) that the Prophet (ﷺ) said:

أَتَتْهَا أَوْ سَمِعَتْ لَهُمْ وَهِيَ لِمَنْ مَاتَ وَلَا يُشْرِكُ بِاللَّهِ شَيْئًا

“Intercession is vast for my Ummah, as it is for every person who dies without associating anything with Allah.”

Hadith 14:

Ṭabarānī in Al-Mu‘jam al-Awsaṭ narrates from Abū Hurayrah (رضي الله عنه) that the Prophet (ﷺ) said:

إِنِّي جَهَنَّمَ فَأَصْرَبُ بِأَبْوَابِهَا فَيُفْتَحُ لِي فَأَدْخُلُهَا فَأَحْمَدُ اللَّهَ مَا حَمِدَ أَحَدٌ قَبْلِي وَمِثْلَهَا وَلَا يَحْمَدُ أَحَدٌ بَعْدِي ثُمَّ أَخْرَجُ مِنْهَا
مَنْ قَالَ: لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ

“I will come to Hell and strike its door, and it will be opened for me. I will then enter it and praise Allah with praises that no one before me has ever expressed and no one after me will express in the same way. Then, I will remove from it every person who has sincerely said, “There is no god but Allah.”

Hadith 15:

Ḥākim (with authentication), Ṭabarānī, and Bayhaqī narrate from ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Abbās (رضي الله عنهما) that the Prophet (ﷺ) said:

يُوضَعُ لِلْأَنْبِيَاءِ مَنَابِرُ مِنْ ذَهَبٍ فَيَجْلِسُونَ عَلَيْهَا وَيَبْقَى مِنْبَرِي لَا أَجْلِسُ عَلَيْهِ أَوْ لَا أَقْعُدُ عَلَيْهِ قَائِمًا بَيْنَ يَدَيَّ رَبِّي مَخَافَةً أَنْ يُبْعَثَنِي إِلَى الْجَنَّةِ وَيَبْقَى أُمِّي بَعْدِي فَأَقُولُ: يَا رَبِّ أُمِّي أُمِّي فَيَقُولُ اللَّهُ عَزَّوَجَلَّ: يَا مُحَمَّدُ مَا تُرِيدُ أَنْ أَصْنَعَ بِأُمَّتِكَ ^{وَاللَّهُ} فَأَقُولُ: يَا رَبِّ عَجَلْ حَسَابَهُمْ فَمَا أَزَالُ أَشْفَعُ حَتَّى أُعْطَى صَكَكَابِرِجَالٍ قَدْ بَعِثَ بِهِمْ إِلَى النَّارِ حَتَّى أَنْ مَالِكًا حَازِنَ النَّارِ يَقُولُ: يَا مُحَمَّدُ مَا تَرَكْتَ لِعَظَمِ رَبِّكَ فِي أُمَّتِكَ مِنْ نِعْمَةٍ

“Golden pulpits will be set up for the Prophets, and they will sit upon them. But my pulpit will remain, and I will not sit upon it; rather, I will stand before my Lord, fearing that He may send me to Paradise while my Ummah remains behind. So I will plead, ‘O my Lord, my Ummah, my Ummah! ’Allah (عَزَّوَجَلَّ) will say, ‘O Muhammad! What do you want me to do with your Ummah? ’I will reply, ‘O my Lord! Hasten their reckoning. ’I will continue to intercede until I am given the release decrees for men who had already been sent to Hell, to the point that Mālik, the keeper of Hell, will say: ‘O Muhammad! You have left no room for your Lord’s anger upon your Ummah.”

May Allah grant us the honour of benefiting from the intercession of the Prophet (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) on the Day of Judgment. Āmin.

Hadiths 16–21:

Bukhārī, Muslim, and Nas ā’ī narrate from Jābir ibn ‘Abdullāh (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ).

Aḥmad (with a Hasan chain), Bukhārī (Tārīkh), Bazzār, Ṭabarānī, Bayhaqī, and Abū Nu‘aym narrate from ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Abbās (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا).

Aḥmad (with a Hasan chain), Bazzār (with a jayyid chain), Dārimī, Ibn Abī Shaybah, Abū Ya‘lā, Abū Nu‘aym, and Bayhaqī narrate from Abū Dharr (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ).

Ṭabarānī in Al-Mu‘jam al-Awsaṭ narrates from Abū Sa‘īd al-Khudrī (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ).

Ṭabarānī in Al-Mu‘jam al-Kabīr narrates from S‘āib ibn Yazīd (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ).

Aḥmad (with a Hasan chain), Ibn Abī Shaybah, and Ṭabarānī narrate from Abū Mūsā al-Ash‘arī (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ).

The narration follows the wording of Jābir (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ) in which he reports that

the Prophet (ﷺ) said:

وَأُعْطِيتُ مَا لَمْ يُعْطَ أَحَدٌ قَبْلِي... وَأُعْطِيتُ الشَّفَاعَةَ

“I have been given that which no one before me has been given... and I have been granted intercession.”

These six hadiths state that the Prophet (ﷺ) said:

“I have been appointed as an intercessor, and intercession has been granted exclusively to me. No other Prophet was given this position except me.”

Hadiths 22 & 23:

In these same hadiths, Ibn ‘Abbās, Abū Saī‘d, and Abū Mūsā (رضي الله عنهم) narrate a statement, which is also reported by Aḥmad, Bukhārī, and Muslim from Sayyiduna Anas (رضي الله عنه) and by Bukhārī and Muslim from Abū Hurayrah (رضي الله عنه):

إِنَّ لِكُلِّ نَبِيٍّ دَعْوَةً قَدْ دَعَا بِهَا فِي أُمَّتِهِ وَاسْتُجِيبَ لَهُ

“Every Prophet was granted a special supplication which he made for his Ummah, and it was accepted.”

Alternative wordings of the hadith from other narrators:

Abū Saī‘d (رضي الله عنه) narrates:

لَيْسَ مِنْ نَبِيٍّ إِلَّا وَقَدْ أُعْطِيَ دَعْوَةً فَتَعَجَّلَهَا

“There is no Prophet except that he was granted a special supplication, and he used it in this world.”

Ibn ‘Abbās (رضي الله عنه) narrates:

لَمْ يَبْقَ نَبِيٌّ إِلَّا أُعْطِيَ سَوْكُهُ

“No Prophet remained except that he was given his requested supplication.”

Returning to the narration of Anas (رضي الله عنه), the Prophet (ﷺ) said:

وَإِنِّي اخْتَبَيْتُ دَعْوَتِي شَفَاعَةً لِّأُمَّتِي يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ

“I have reserved my supplication for the intercession of my Ummah on the Day of Judgement.”

Abū Mūsā (رضي الله عنه) adds:

جَعَلْتُهَا لِمَنْ مَاتَ مِنْ أُمَّتِي لَا يُشْرِكُ بِاللَّهِ شَيْئًا

“I have kept it for every member of my Ummah who dies without associating anything with Allāh.”

Explanation:

Although all the Prophets (عَلَيْهِمُ السَّلَام) had their supplications accepted, one special supplication was given to each of them, with an assurance of acceptance. All the Prophets from Adam to T'sā (عَلَيْهِمُ السَّلَام) used this supplication in this world, but our Prophet (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) saved his supplication for the Hereafter.

He said:

“I have kept it for the intercession of my Ummah on the Day of Judgement. I have reserved it for my entire Ummah, every person who leaves this world with faith.”

الله اكبر!

O sinful ones of this Ummah! Have you not witnessed the immense kindness and mercy of your beloved Prophet (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ)?

He was granted three requests from the Divine Court, where he could ask for anything, and it would be granted. Yet, he did not use a single one for himself; instead, he spent all three for the benefit of his Ummah:

1. The first two were made in this world for his Ummah.
2. The third one was reserved for the Hereafter, for the greatest need of his followers, when no one else will be able to help.

On that day, only the Merciful Master and Compassionate Prophet (ﷺ) will stand as an intercessor for his Ummah.

Indeed, Allah the Most High spoke the truth when He said:

عَزِيزٌ عَلَيْهِ مَا عَنِتُّمْ حَرِيصٌ عَلَيْكُمْ بِأُمُومِينَ زَعُوفٌ رَجِئٌ

anxious is he by what you endure, deeply concerned for your wellbeing, exceptionally gracious, merciful to the believers.¹

By Allāh, the Almighty!

No mother is as compassionate to her beloved only son as he (ﷺ) is to each and every member of his Ummah!

O Allah! You know our weakness and inability, and You know the great rights of the Prophet (ﷺ) over us.

O Most Powerful! O Most Generous!

Send limitless blessings and peace upon him and his family, in accordance with his immense mercy towards his Ummah, and in accordance with Your immense mercy towards him (ﷺ).

سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ!

Yet, how have some members of this Ummah repaid this immense love and mercy of the Prophet (ﷺ)?

Some raise doubts about his superiority!

Some limit their praises for him!

Some oppose his veneration and respect!

Some label expressions of love for him as innovations!

¹ Al-Quran, Al-Tawbah, verse 128; translation from Kanz al-ʿIrfān

Some even declare reverence for him as shirk (associating partners with Allah)!

إِنَّا لِلّٰهِ وَإِنَّا إِلَيْهِ رَاجِعُونَ

“Indeed, we belong to Allah, and indeed, to Him we shall return.”

وَسَيَعْلَمُ الَّذِينَ ظَلَمُوا أَيَّ مُنْقَلَبٍ يَنْقَلِبُونَ ﴿٢٢٢﴾

“Soon the oppressors will come to know to which end they will return.”¹

وَلَا حَوْلَ وَلَا قُوَّةَ إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ الْعَلِيِّ الْعَظِيمِ

“There is no power and no strength except with Allāh, the Most High, the Most Great.”

اللهم صَلِّ وَسَلِّمْ وَبَارِكْ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَىٰ آلِهِ وَصَحْبِهِ قَدْ رَأَيْتِهِ وَرَحْمَتِهِ بِأَمْتِهِ وَقَدْ رَأَيْتِكَ وَرَحْمَتِكَ بِهِ آمِينَ

“O Allāh! Send blessings, peace, and blessings upon him, upon his family, and upon his companions, in proportion to his mercy and compassion for his Ummah, and in proportion to Your mercy and compassion for him. Āmin, O Lord of Truth! Āmin!”

Hadith 24:

In Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim, it is narrated from Ubayy ibn Ka'b (رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ) that the Prophet (صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) said:

اللَّهُمَّ اغْفِرْ لَأُمَّتِي، اللَّهُمَّ اغْفِرْ لَأُمَّتِي

“O Allāh! Forgive my Ummah. O Allāh! Forgive my Ummah.”

وَأَخَّرْتُ الثَّالِثَةَ لِيَوْمٍ يَرْغَبُ إِلَيْهِ الْخَلْقُ حَتَّىٰ إِبْرَاهِيمَ

“And I have reserved the third supplication for the Day when all of creation, even Ibrahim (عَلَيْهِ السَّلَام) will seek my help.”

¹ Al-Quran, Al-Shu'ara, verse 227; translation from Kanz al-'Irfān

وَصَلِّ وَسَلِّمْ وَبَارِكْ عَلَيْهِ وَالْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ

“O Allah! Send blessings, peace, and blessings upon him, and all praise is due to Allah, the Lord of all worlds.”

Hadith 25:

Bayhaqī narrates from Abū Hurayrah (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ) that on the Night of Ascension (Isr'ā), the Prophet (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) said to his Lord:

“You have granted the Prophets (عَلَيْهِمُ السَّلَام) various merits.”

Then, the Majestic Lord replied:

أَعْطَيْتُكَ خَيْرًا مِنْ ذَلِكَ -إِلَى قَوْلِهِ : -حَبَأْتُ شَفَاعَتَكَ وَلَمْ أَحْبَأْهَا لِبَنِي عَدْنِكَ

“I have granted you something better than all of that, I have reserved intercession for you, and I have not granted this to any other Prophet.”

Hadith 26:

Ibn Abī Shaybah, Tirmidhī (who authenticated it), Ibn Mājah, and Ḥākim (who declared it Ṣaḥīḥ) narrate from Ubayy ibn Ka'b (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ) that the Prophet (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) said:

إِذَا كَانَ يَوْمُ الْقِيَامَةِ كُنْتُ إِمَامَ النَّبِيِّينَ وَخَطِيبَهُمْ وَصَاحِبَ شَفَاعَتِهِمْ غَيْرَ فُخْرٍ

“On the Day of Judgement, I will be the leader of the Prophets, their orator, and the one with the right to intercede for them, and this is not out of pride.”

Hadiths 27–40:

Ibn Man 'narrates from Zayd ibn Arqam (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ) and fourteen other Companions (رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ) that the Prophet (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) said:

شَفَاعَتِي يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ حَقٌّ فَمَنْ لَمْ يُؤْمِنْ بِهِ أَلَمْ يَكُنْ مِنْ أَهْلِهَا

“My intercession on the Day of Judgement is true, and whoever does not

believe in it will not be eligible for it.”

A denier should look at this mutawātir (mass-transmitted) hadith, have mercy on himself, and believe in the intercession of the Prophet (ﷺ).

Supplication for Intercession:

اللَّهُمَّ إِنَّكَ تَعْلَمُ هَدَيْتَ قَوْمًا بِشَفَاعَةِ حَبِيبِكَ مُحَمَّدٍ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فَأَجْعَلْنَا مِنْ أَهْلِهَا فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ يَا أَهْلَ
الشَّقْوَى وَأَهْلَ الْمَغْفِرَةِ وَاجْعَلْ أَشْرَفَ صَلَوَاتِكَ وَأَتْقَى بَرَكَاتِكَ وَأَزْكَى تَحِيَّاتِكَ عَلَى هَذَا الْحَبِيبِ الْمُحِبِّبِ وَالشَّفِيعِ الْمُرْتَجَى وَعَلَى
آلِهِ وَصَحْبِهِ دَائِمًا أَبَدًا، آمِينَ يَا أَرْحَمَ الرَّاحِمِينَ وَالْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ

“O Allāh! You know that You have guided us, and we have believed in the intercession of Your beloved Muhammad (ﷺ). So make us worthy of it in this world and the Hereafter, O Possessor of Taqwā and Forgiveness! Send the noblest of Your blessings, the most abundant of Your Barakah, and the purest of Your greetings upon this chosen beloved, the expected intercessor, and upon his family and companions forever.

Ameen, O Most Merciful of the Merciful! And all praise belongs to Allāh, the Lord of all worlds.”

Translator's Dua:

May Allāh Almighty Shower His Endless Mercy and Blessings upon Imām e 'Ishq o Mahabbat, Muhsin e Ahl e Sunnat, Qaati e Najdiyyat, Māhiy e Bid'at, Ālim e Shar'at, Mujadid e Deen o Millat, Hazrat Allāmah Mawlānā Al-Hafiz Al-Qāri Ash-Shah Imam Ahmad Raza Khān Muhaddith e Bareli تَوَدَّ اللَّهُ مَرْقَدَهُ وَنَفَعْنَا اللَّهُ بِهِ.

آمِينَ بِجَاهِ خَاتَمِ النَّبِيِّينَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ

The forever in need of Divine Mercy and Forgiveness;

Bilal Shabir Attari Madani.

اَلْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِيْنَ وَالصَّلٰوةُ وَالسَّلَامُ عَلٰى سَيِّدِ الْمُرْسَلِيْنَ اَنَّا بَعْدُ قَاعُوْذُ بِاللّٰهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطٰنِ الرَّجِيْمِ بِسْمِ اللّٰهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيْمِ



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